



Sultan Ahmed

MERCHANDISING OPERATIONS LEAD — LINGERIE & NIGHTWEAR · 8.5+ YEARS BUYING OFFICE & FACTORY EXPERIENCE

UK PREMIUM BUYER ACCOUNTS · GARMENT CONSTRUCTION & LECTRA CAD · COSTING & NEGOTIATION · END-TO-END PRODUCT LIFECYCLE

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PROFESSIONAL SUMMARY

Lingerie and Nightwear Merchandising operations lead with **8.5+ years** of specialised end-to-end merchandising experience across UK buying offices and factory environments. Currently serving as sole Bangladesh merchandising lead within a **UK liaison buying office**, independently managing **8 reputed UK buyer accounts** — including Ann Summers, Boux Avenue, Bravissimo, Lemonade Dolls, Blue Bella, Snag, George, and Next — from concept development through bulk execution to final shipment. Deep specialist knowledge in **lingerie and nightwear garment construction, pattern corrections, and material consumption calculations**, supported by hands-on proficiency in **Lectra CAD software** for immediate production line problem-solving. Independently prepare detailed **costing sheets with full BOM breakdowns**, manage lab dip and trim approvals, and coordinate colour and quality testing for buyer sign-off. Proven expertise executing **premium-range, complex, low-MOQ styles at high retail price points** alongside core basic programs — having managed **500+ styles, 100+ seasonal ranges, and 3M+ pieces** at **~92–98% OTIF delivery**. Strong cross-functional communicator, adept at managing buyer relationships, design teams, factories, and internal QA, technical, and sourcing teams with equal fluency. BSc & MSc in Textile Engineering (DUET); currently completing Postgraduate Diploma in Garments Business at IBA, University of Dhaka.

8.5+ YEARS EXPERIENCE	8 FACTORY PARTNERS MANAGED	~92–98% OTIF PERFORMANCE	500+ STYLES PER SEASON	3M+ PIECES MANAGED	5–8% FOB COST SAVINGS
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CORE STRENGTHS FOR THIS ROLE

- Independent execution of lingerie and nightwear products end-to-end — development to final shipment — across 8 UK buyer accounts
- Smooth daily communication with customers and suppliers on approvals, critical path, and production activities
- Arrange and manage lab dips, trims, bulk fabric colour, and quality testing for buyer approval
- Premium-range, low-MOQ, high-retail-price product expertise alongside core basic styling programs
- Compliance oversight: GOTS, OCS, OEKO-TEX, BSCI/SMETA across multi-factory programs
- Deep specialist knowledge in lingerie & nightwear garment construction, pattern corrections, and Lectra CAD usages
- Preparation of detailed costing sheets with full breakdowns — BOM, trims, fabric, labour, FOB
- Close collaboration with design teams to develop quality samples on time against customer requirements
- 8.5+ years in multinational buying offices & garment factories — buying house environment specialist
- BSc & MSc Textile Engineering; Lectra CAD; IBA PGD-GB (in progress)

PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

Merchandising Operations Lead — Lingerie & Nightwear

December 2023 – Present

AURA (UK) Liaison Office Bangladesh · Uttara, Dhaka

- Sole Bangladesh merchandising lead for AURA UK — independently leading full product lifecycle across **8 reputed UK buyer accounts: Ann Summers, Boux Avenue, Bravissimo, Lemonade Dolls, Blue Bella, Snag, George, and Next**.
- Execute **premium-range lingerie products** — complex constructions, high retail price points, low MOQ — alongside core basic styling orders, with complete ownership from concept through bulk shipment.
- Maintain smooth, daily communications with customers and suppliers on merchandising activities, approvals, and critical-path milestones, acting as primary Bangladesh point of contact for all buyer queries.

- Understand customer requirements and closely coordinate with design teams to develop and approve **quality samples within buyer time frames**, resolving fit, construction, and quality issues promptly.
- Arrange and track **lab dips, trims, bulk fabric colour submissions, and quality tests** through to customer approval across 8 manufacturing partners.
- Prepare accurate **costing sheets with all necessary breakdowns** (fabric, trims, CMT, embellishments, packaging, freight) supporting buyer negotiations and margin reviews; consistently achieve **5–8% cost savings** against first-quoted FOB.
- Apply specialist knowledge of **lingerie and nightwear garment construction, pattern corrections, and material usages calculations** — using **Lectra CAD software** for consumption analysis and immediate production line problem-solving.
- Develop and manage T&A plans and production critical paths across all milestones; proactively resolve delays through direct factory engagement and visits to sustain **~92–98% OTIF delivery** across 500+ styles and 3M+ pieces.
- Lead a direct merchandising team, allocating workload across factory partners, reviewing output against buyer commitments, and mentoring junior merchandisers on costing, T&A planning, and buyer communication.
- Ensure compliance with buyer standards, quality requirements and sustainability frameworks (**GOTS, OCS, OEKO-TEX, BSCI/SMETA**); prepare production forecasts and status reports for buyer and senior management review.

Senior Merchandiser — Lingerie & Nightwear

April 2021 – November 2023

AURA (UK) Liaison Office Bangladesh · Uttara, Dhaka

- Bangladesh merchandising owner for end-to-end execution across **6 strategic manufacturing partners** supporting AURA UK buying office operations across accounts including **Ann Summers, Boux Avenue, Bravissimo, Lemonade Dolls, Blue Bella, and Snag**.
- Executed both **premium-range complex lingerie and low-MOQ programs** and core basic styling orders for UK buyers — managing garment construction technicalities, pattern correction feedback, and material consumption calculations.
- Applied **Lectra CAD software** for fabric usages analysis and supportive production line solutions; provided technical guidance to factories to resolve immediate construction challenges.
- Oversaw approximately **300 styles across 20 seasonal ranges** maintaining **~98% OTIF delivery**; managed 1M+ pieces across multi-season buyer programs.
- Performed advanced open costing including **BOM validation, margin review, and Lectra-based material consumption calculation**; negotiated SMV, MOQ, MCQ and surcharges directly with customers and suppliers.
- Arranged and tracked lab dips, trims, bulk fabric colour, and quality test submissions for customer approval; coordinated with design team on sample development within buyer time frames.
- Coordinated with UK and China teams on design development, sourcing strategy, costing approvals, and order execution; managed critical path and factory capacity planning.

Merchandiser — Lingerie & Nightwear

July 2018 – March 2021

Crystal International · Factory Environment · Bangladesh

- Managed lingerie and nightwear programs for **H&M, M&S, and George** buyer accounts.
- Handled pre-costing and post-costing analysis aligned with factory IE and **Lectra CAD-based consumption outputs**; supported garment construction reviews and pattern correction processes.
- Conducted **supplier evaluation and selection**; negotiated costing and MOQ optimization to improve commercial efficiency across buyer programs.
- Maintained production critical paths, coordinated factory capacity planning, and managed sample and bulk approvals, bulk inspections, and compliance requirements with QA/QC and technical teams.

Assistant Merchandiser-Lingerie and Nightwear

January 2018 – June 2018

Crystal International · Factory Environment · Bangladesh

- Supported order planning, overseas buyer communication, sample development and shipment follow-up for lingerie and nightwear programs.
- Maintained critical path records and coordinated between development, sourcing and production teams.

CORE SKILLS

COSTING & NEGOTIATION

Open Costing · BOM Validation · Pre & Post Costing · Costing Sheet Preparation (Full Breakdown) · Margin Review · FOB Negotiation · MOQ/MCQ & Surcharge Optimization · Supplier Evaluation & Selection

GARMENT CONSTRUCTION & TECHNICAL

EDUCATION

Postgraduate Diploma in Garments Business (PGD-GB)

Institute of Business Administration (IBA), University of Dhaka
Currently Running

M.Sc. in Textile Engineering

Dhaka University of Engineering & Technology (DUET)
CGPA: 3.25 / 4.00

B.Sc. in Textile Engineering (Apparel Merchandising)

Lingerie & Nightwear Garment Construction · Pattern Correction · Material Usages Calculation · Lectra CAD Software (Consumption & Production Line Support) · Fit & Quality Problem-Solving · Lab Dip, Trim & Bulk Fabric Approval Management

PLANNING & APPROVALS

T&A Planning · Critical Path Management · Sample Development & Approval Tracking (Lab Dips, Trims, Strike-offs) · Bulk Production Monitoring · Product Lifecycle Management · Factory Capacity Planning

BUYER & ACCOUNT MANAGEMENT

UK Premium Buyer Accounts (Ann Summers, Boux Avenue, Bravissimo, Lemonade Dolls, Blue Bella, Snag, George, Next, H&M, M&S) · Cross-functional Coordination · Buyer Reporting & Forecasting · Team Mentoring

PRODUCT SPECIALISATION

Lingerie & Intimate Apparel · Nightwear & Sleepwear · Premium Range Low-MOQ Styles · Core Basic programs · Innerwear · Knitwear · Woven Garments

COMPLIANCE & QUALITY

GOTS · OCS · OEKO-TEX 100 · BSCI/SMETA · RSL/MRSL · Ethical Sourcing · Quality & Delivery Standards Compliance

SOFTWARE & SYSTEMS

Lectra CAD · SAP & PLM Systems · MS Office (Excel — Pivot, V-Lookup; PowerPoint; Word) · Power BI · Adobe Illustrator · CLO 3D

LANGUAGES

Bengali — Native | English — Fluent, Spoken & Written

REFERENCES

Mr. Manoj De Silva

Country Manager, Bangladesh & Sri Lanka

AURA (UK) Liaison Office Bangladesh

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manoj@aura-lingerie.com

Dhaka University of Engineering & Technology (DUET)

CGPA: 3.53 / 4.00

Diploma in Textile Engineering

Textile Institute, Dinajpur

CGPA: 3.82 / 4.00

PROFESSIONAL TRAINING

Advanced Excel, Power BI & Office BSCIC · 2016

Garments CAD — Lectra & CLO3D Udemy · 2022

Adobe Illustrator & Photoshop Coursera · 2020

Retail Merchandising Mathematics Self-directed · 2023

Prof. Dr. Md Abdur Rashid

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